

tessellated petals, 1½–3½in (4–9cm) long, and purple anthers. Has ovate to ovate-elliptic, strongly pleated leaves, which develop after flowering. Z6–10

C. montanum. See *Merendera montana*.

C. ‘Rosy Dawn’. Robust, fall-flowering corm. H 6in (15cm), S 4in (10cm). Has semierect, ovate leaves and bears goblet-shaped then open trumpet-shaped, fragrant, pinkish-violet, lightly tessellated flowers with a prominent white center and petals, 2½–3in (6–8cm) long. Z6–10

C. sibthorpii. See *C. bivonae*.

C. speciosum. Vigorous, fall-flowering corm. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Bears goblet-shaped, pale to deep pinkish-purple flowers, often with white throats, and petals 1¾–3in (4.5–8cm) long. Large, semierect, basal leaves develop in winter or spring. Z6–10. ‘**Album**’ illus. p.424. ‘**Atrorubens**’ has deep red-purple flowers.

C. ‘The Giant’. Robust, fall-flowering corm. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Produces somewhat goblet-shaped, purplish-violet flowers, with white bases and lightly tessellated petals, to 3in (8cm) long. Semierect, narrowly ovate, basal leaves form in winter or spring. Z6–10

C. trigynum. See *Merendera trigyna*.

C. variegatum. Fall-flowering corm. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Bears widely funnel-shaped, short-tubed, violet- to pinkish-purple flowers with strongly tessellated petals, ¾–1in (2–2.5cm) long. More or less horizontal, basal leaves with wavy margins are produced in spring. Needs a hot, sunny site. Z6–10

C. ‘Violet Queen’. Fall-flowering corm. H 6in (15cm), S 4in (10cm). Produces semierect, broadly lance-shaped leaves and funnel-shaped, fragrant, pinkish-violet flowers with strongly tessellated, pointed petals, 1½–2½in (4–6cm) long. Z6–10

C. ‘Waterlily’ illus. p.425.

COLEONEMA

RUTACEAE

Genus of evergreen, heathlike shrubs, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Requires a position in full sun and well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Water potted plants moderately when in full growth, sparingly at other times. For a more compact habit, clip after flowering. Propagate by seed sown in spring or by semiripe cuttings in late summer.

C. pulchellum, syn. *C. pulchrum* of gardens. Freely branching evergreen shrub, erect at first, then spreading. H and S 3–4ft (1–1.2m). Bears linear, bright green leaves and numerous pale pink flowers, ¼–½in (7–8mm) across, from late spring to summer. Z8–11. ‘**Golden Sunset**’ see ‘Sunset Gold’. ‘**Sunset Gold**’ (syn. *C.p.* ‘Golden Sunset’) has glowing, yellow-green leaves.

C. pulchrum of gardens. See *C. pulchellum*.

Coleus. See *Solenostemon* except for: *C. thyrsoides* for which see *Plectranthus thyrsoideus*.

COLLETIA

RHAMNACEAE

Genus of deciduous, usually leafless shrubs, grown for their curious, spiny

shoots and profuse, small flowers. Shoots assume function of leaves. Requires a sheltered, sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer.

C. armata. See *C. hystrix*.

C. cruciata. See *C. paradoxa*.

C. hystrix, syn. *C. armata*, illus. p.130. ‘**Rosea**’ is a deciduous, sturdy-branched shrub. H 8ft (2.5m), S 15ft (5m). Shoots have rigid, gray-green spines. Bears fragrant, tubular, pink flowers in late summer and early fall. Z7–10

C. paradoxa, syn. *C. cruciata*, illus. p.131.

COLOCASIA

ARACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, perennial, marginal water plants, grown for their foliage. Has edible tubers, known as “taros,” for which it is widely cultivated. Suitable for the edges of frost-free ponds; may also be grown in wet soil in pots. Grows in sun or light shade and in mud or shallow water. Propagate by division in spring. ☉ All parts may cause mild stomach upset if ingested without cooking, and contact with the sap may irritate the skin.

C. antiquorum. See *C. esculenta*.

C. esculenta, syn. *C. antiquorum*. ‘**Fontanesii**’ is a deciduous, perennial, marginal water plant. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has large, bold, , mid-green leaves with dark green veins and margins and blackish-violet leaf stalks and spathe tubes. ‘**Illustris**’ has brownish-purple leaf stalks and dark green leaf blades with purple spots. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C or 70°F/21°C to remain evergreen)

COLQUHOUNIA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen shrubs and subshrubs, grown for their flowers in late summer and fall. Cut to ground level in cold winters. Needs a sheltered, sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.

C. coccinea illus. p.141.

COLUMNEA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs or subshrubs, with trailing or pendent shoots, and occasionally scandent climbers, grown for their showy flowers. Trailing species are useful for hanging baskets. Needs bright but indirect light, a fairly humid atmosphere and moist soil, except in winter. Propagate by tip cuttings after flowering.

C. x banksii illus. p.470.

C. crassifolia illus. p.470.

C. gloriosa (Goldfish plant). Evergreen, trailing subshrub with stems branching only at the base. H and S to 3ft (90cm). Ovate or ovate-oblong leaves are densely covered in fine purple hairs; leaf margins are turned under. Bears tubular, hooded, hairy, scarlet flowers, to 3in (8cm) long, with yellow throats, in winter–spring. Z9–11 (min. 59°F/15°C)

C. microphylla. Evergreen, trailing subshrub. H and S 3ft (1m) or more. Has close-set, small, ovate to rounded, dark

green leaves with red-brown hairs. Hooded, tubular, hairy, scarlet flowers, to 3in (8cm) long, with yellow throats, are produced in winter–spring. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C) ‘**Variegata**’ illus. p.475.

COLUTEA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering shrubs, sometimes trees, grown for their foliage, pealike flowers and bladder-shaped seed pods. Grow in full sun and any but waterlogged soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall. ☉ Seeds may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.

C. arborescens (Bladder senna) illus. p.139.

C. x media illus. p.140.

C. orientalis. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Blue-gray leaves consist of 7 or 9 leaflets. Clusters of yellow-marked, coppery-red flowers, produced in summer, are followed by inflated, green, then pale brown seed pods. Z6–10

Comarum. See *Potentilla*.

COMBRETUM

COMBRETACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen, sometimes briefly deciduous trees and shrubs, some more or less scandent, grown for their small, showy flowers. Provide humus-rich, well-drained soil, with partial shade in summer. Water freely in summer, less at other times. Support for stems is necessary. Thin out and spur back congested growth after flowering. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be a problem.

C. grandiflorum. Moderately vigorous, evergreen, scandent to twining climber. H to 20ft (6m). Has oblong to elliptic, pointed leaves, 4–8in (10–20cm) long. Bears one-sided spikes, 4–5in (10–13cm) long, of tubular, bright red flowers with long stamens in summer. Z12 (min. 61°F/16°C)

C. indicum, syn. *Quisqualis indica* (Rangoon creeper), illus. p.462.

COMMELINA

COMMELINACEAE

Genus of perennials, usually grown as annuals.

Grow in a sunny, sheltered site in fertile, well-drained soil. Lift crowns before frosts and overwinter in slightly moist, frost-free conditions. Propagate by seed sown under glass or by division of the crown in spring.

C. coelestis, syn. *C. tuberosa* Coelestis Group (Day flower), illus. p.315.

C. tuberosa Coelestis Group. See *C. coelestis*.

CONANDRON

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of one species of tuberous, evergreen perennial, grown for its fleshy leaves and nodding flower clusters. Grow in an alpine house. Requires a position in shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Keep containerized plants moist in summer, dry when dormant in winter. Propagate by division or seed in spring.

C. ramondoides. Hummock-forming, tuberous perennial. H 12in (30cm), S 8in (20cm). Bears broadly , fleshy, wrinkled, mid-green leaves with toothed edges. In midsummer, each flower stem bears 5–25 tubular flowers, usually lilac, but white, purple or pink forms also occur. Z9–11

CONIFERS

Group of trees and shrubs distinguished botanically from others by producing seeds exposed or uncovered on the scales of fruits. Most conifers are evergreen, have needlelike leaves and bear woody fruits (cones). All genera in the Cupressaceae family, however, have needlelike juvenile leaves and, excepting many junipers and some other selected forms, scalelike adult leaves. Conifers described in this book are evergreen unless otherwise stated.

Conifers are excellent garden plants. Most provide year-round foliage, which may be green, blue, gray, bronze, gold or silver. They range in height from trees 130ft (40m) or more tall to dwarf shrubs that grow less than 2in (5cm) every 10 years. Tall conifers may be planted as specimen trees or to provide shelter, screening or hedging. Dwarf conifers are good feature plants in their own right, as well as in groups; they also associate well with heathers, add variety to rock gardens and provide excellent groundcover. They may also be grown in containers.

Hardiness

Nearly all conifers described in this book are hardy. Some, such as *Picea sitchensis*, *P. omorika* and *Pinus contorta*, thrive in the coldest, most windswept sites. *Araucaria*, *Cupressus* and *Pinus* are good for coastal conditions. *Athrotaxis*, *Austrocedrus*, *Cephalotaxus*, *Podocarpus* and certain species noted in other genera flourish only in mild-winter regions. Elsewhere they need a very sheltered position or may be grown indoors as dwarf plants.

Frost may damage new growth of several genera, especially *Abies*, *Larix*, *Picea* and *Pseudotsuga*, and severe cold, dry spells in winter may temporarily harm mature foliage.

Position and soil

Cupressus, x *Cuprocyparis*, *Larix* and *Pinus* need full sun. *Cedrus*, *Juniperus* and *Pseudolarix* prefer a sunny site, but tolerate light shade. All other conifers will thrive in sun or shade, and most *Abies* and all *Cephalotaxus*, *Podocarpus*, *Taxus*, *Thuja*, *Torreya* and *Tsuga* will grow in deep shade once established. *Wollemia* prefers a sheltered location out of full sun.

Conifers grow well on most soils, but certain genera and species will not do well on soils over chalk or limestone. In this book, such conifers are: *Abies*, *Pseudolarix*, *Pseudotsuga* and *Tsuga*; also *Picea*, except *P. likiangensis*, *P. omorika* and *P. pungens*; and *Pinus*, except *P. aristata*, *P. armandii*, *P. cembroides*, *P. halepensis*, *P. heldreichii*, *P. nigra*, *P. peuce* and *P. wallichiana*.

Certain conifers tolerate extreme conditions. *Abies alba*, *A. homolepis*, *A. nordmanniana*, *Cryptomeria*, *Cunninghamia*, *Metasequoia*, *Pinus coulteri*,